

AI Technology Consulting Scoring Framework — v0.1 Draft

Version 0.1 Draft · May 2026 · Full review: Week 3

■ DRAFT — NOT FINAL. This is a v0.1 placeholder from Week 0. Definitions, weights, and thresholds will be confirmed in Week 3.

1. Purpose

This framework defines how each company is evaluated across six consulting categories using publicly available information only. Scores drive company rankings, risk classification, and Power BI dashboard insights.

- Rank companies by overall AI readiness
- Assign a risk level — Low, Moderate, High, or Very High
- Drive Power BI visuals and consulting-style recommendations

2. Scoring Scale

Every category is scored 1–5 using the definitions below.

Score	Label	What it means
1	Very Weak	Little to no public evidence found
2	Limited	Some evidence but incomplete or unclear
3	Moderate	Clear evidence present, with some gaps
4	Strong	Consistent, well-documented evidence
5	Very Strong	Comprehensive, leading-practice evidence

Rule: Score based only on what is publicly visible. When evidence is absent or unclear, score lower and flag the entry as 'Needs Review.' Never infer without a traceable source.

3. Scoring Categories

3.1 AI Readiness

Weight: 20%

Measures how clearly the company demonstrates AI adoption, active products, investment, or a published strategy.

What to look for:

- AI strategy statements in annual reports or public filings
- Named AI products, tools, or platform launches
- AI partnerships, job postings, or press releases

Score guidance:

- 1–2 No or minimal public mention of AI
- 3 Some AI activity visible but limited in scope
- 4–5 Clear strategy, active deployments, measurable outcomes

3.2 Data Privacy Maturity

Weight: 20%

Measures how transparently the company explains its data privacy practices and user data handling.

What to look for:

- Clear, detailed, and accessible privacy policy
- User controls — opt-out, deletion, and data portability
- Compliance language — GDPR, CCPA, HIPAA, or equivalent

Score guidance:

- 1–2 Vague or missing privacy policy, no user controls
- 3 Standard policy with partial transparency
- 4–5 Detailed, user-friendly practices with certifications

3.3 Cybersecurity Maturity

Weight: 20%

Measures visible evidence of cybersecurity controls, named frameworks, and public security posture.

What to look for:

- Dedicated security page or trust center
- Named certifications — SOC 2, ISO 27001, NIST, FedRAMP
- Incident response transparency or vulnerability disclosure programs

Score guidance:

- 1–2 No security page, no certifications, no public stance
- 3 Basic security content or partial certifications visible
- 4–5 Trust center, named frameworks, detailed security posture

3.4 AI Governance & Accountability

Weight: 20%

Measures whether the company shows published ethics policies, oversight structures, and responsible AI commitments.

What to look for:

- Responsible AI or ethics principles published
- Named governance board, review committee, or approval process
- Transparency about how AI-based decisions are made or appealed

Score guidance:

- 1–2 No mention of AI governance or ethics
- 3 Some responsible AI language but no formal structure
- 4–5 Published principles, named processes, clear accountability

3.5 Automation Opportunity

Weight: 10%

Estimates where the company has meaningful potential to gain efficiency through automation or AI-enabled workflows.

What to look for:

- High-volume repetitive processes — claims, billing, logistics, scheduling
- Customer service, HR, finance, or operations at scale
- Publicly stated digital transformation goals

Score guidance:

- 1–2 Few visible manual processes or already automated
- 3 Moderate volume with some automation potential
- 4–5 Large-scale manual operations — strong opportunity

Note: Higher score = more opportunity. This is a positive consulting signal, not a risk flag.

3.6 Implementation Complexity

Weight: 10%

Estimates how difficult AI implementation may be based on visible organizational factors.

What to look for:

- Industry regulation level — healthcare and finance score higher
- Company size, number of business units, or geographic spread
- Likely legacy infrastructure or data sensitivity requirements

Score guidance:

- 1–2 Small company, low regulation, likely modern systems
- 3 Mid-size or moderate regulatory exposure
- 4–5 Large, heavily regulated, multi-unit with legacy systems

Note: Higher score = more complexity — treated as a risk flag. Direction is opposite to other categories. See Q1, Section 7.

4. Overall Readiness Score (0 – 100)

Each category score (1–5) is multiplied by its weight, then scaled to produce a final score out of 100.

Category	Weight
AI Readiness	20%
Data Privacy Maturity	20%
Cybersecurity Maturity	20%
AI Governance & Accountability	20%
Automation Opportunity	10%
Implementation Complexity	10%
Total	100%

■ Formula

$$\text{Weighted Score} = (\text{AI} \times 0.20) + (\text{Privacy} \times 0.20) + (\text{Cyber} \times 0.20) + (\text{Governance} \times 0.20) + (\text{Automation} \times 0.10) + (\text{Complexity} \times 0.10)$$
$$\text{Overall Score (0 – 100)} = \text{Weighted Score} \times 20$$

■ Worked Example

Scores: AI=4 Privacy=3 Cyber=3 Governance=2 Automation=4 Complexity=3 Weighted = $(4 \times .20) + (3 \times .20) + (3 \times .20) + (2 \times .20) + (4 \times .10) + (3 \times .10) = 0.80 + 0.60 + 0.60 + 0.40 + 0.40 + 0.30 = 3.10$ Overall Score = $3.10 \times 20 = 62 / 100$

5. Risk Level Classification

After scoring, each company is assigned a risk level. Thresholds below are placeholders — review after the first 15–20 companies are scored.

Overall Score (0–100)	Risk Level
80 – 100	Low Risk
60 – 79	Moderate Risk
40 – 59	High Risk
0 – 39	Very High Risk

6. Scoring Rules & Quality Standards

Apply these standards consistently across every company in the dataset.

Public sources only. Every score must trace to at least one source URL in the dataset.

Score lower when uncertain. Absence of public evidence is itself a signal — do not give benefit of the doubt.

Flag unclear data. If a category cannot be scored confidently, set Verification Status to 'Needs Review.'

Stay consistent. The same visible evidence must produce the same score regardless of company size or fame.

No reputation proxy. A well-known brand is not automatically a high scorer. Score only what is publicly visible.

Document assumptions. If a score relies on inference, note it clearly in the corresponding Notes column.

7. Open Questions — Week 3 Review

These concerns were identified in Week 0 and must be resolved before scores are finalized.

Q1 — Implementation Complexity direction

Complexity scores higher when things are harder — opposite of all other categories. Should it be inverted in the formula, or kept as a separate standalone risk signal?

Q2 — Weight distribution

All four main categories share a flat 20% weight. Should Governance weigh more for regulated industries like healthcare and finance?

Q3 — Risk threshold calibration

Current thresholds are placeholders. Review distribution after 15–20 companies are scored and adjust if needed.

Q4 — Cybersecurity and breach history

Should confirmed public breaches reduce the Cybersecurity score, or rely only on posture signals like certifications?

Q5 — Industry baseline differences

Healthcare scores higher on privacy by default (HIPAA). Should the framework adjust for industry-level baseline expectations?

Q6 — Incomplete data handling

Should partial scores be calculated when only 4 of 6 categories are filled, or marked 'Scoring Incomplete'?

8. Version History

Version	Date	Notes
v0.1	May 2026	Initial draft — Week 0 planning phase. Not final. Pending Week 3 review.